Exp 9: Exploring AI-Assisted Features and Built-in Analytics (Zia) in Zoho Creator

1. Aim

To explore, evaluate, and implement artificial intelligence-assisted capabilities (Zia AI assistant, Natural Language Querying, OCR document processing) and built-in analytical chart widgets within Zoho Creator for the Vehicle Services & Repair Request application.

2. Procedure

Step 1: Configure Built-in Analytics & Visual Reports

Utilized Zoho Creator's Page Builder and Report palette to design visual analytical components on top of the Service_Request_Form Report dataset:

- **Service Type Distribution (Donut Chart):** Categorizes request volume across Routine Service, Breakdown Repair, and Accident Repair.
- **Vehicle Type Volume (Bar Chart):** Analyzes service distribution across Hatchback, Sedan, SUV, EV, and Commercial vehicles.
- **KPI Summary Metric Cards:** Real-time counters displaying Active Requests, Completed Repairs, and Total Invoiced Revenue.

Step 2: Evaluate Zia AI Natural Language Querying (NLQ)

Tested Zia AI conversational querying capabilities within the platform workspace. Analyzed natural language prompts such as:

- *"Show total service requests grouped by Vehicle Type in August 2026"*
- *"List breakdown repair requests with cost greater than 5000"*

Evaluated how Zia's underlying semantic parser maps plain English tokens to database fields and generates instant chart visualizers without requiring custom queries.

Step 3: Analyze Deluge AI Tasks & Document OCR Processing

Evaluated Zoho Creator's native AI task libraries in Deluge (zoho.creator.ai.extractTextFromImage) for automated optical character recognition on customer document uploads (vehicle registration certificates and insurance papers).

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Step 4: AI Code Assistance & Logic Diagnostics

Tested the built-in AI code assistant in the Deluge Script Editor for contextual auto-completion, syntax validation, and automated error diagnostics.

3. Output

3.1 Built-in Analytics & Dashboard Chart Configuration

The table below summarizes the analytical chart widgets configured on the custom application dashboard:

Widget Type	Widget Title	Source Data Field	Aggregation / Metric	Operational Utility
KPI Metric Card	Total Requests	`Record_ID`	COUNT(All Records)	Monitors overall service center volume
KPI Metric Card	Routine Services	`Service_Type`	COUNT(Service_Type == "Routine")	Tracks routine maintenance workload
Donut Chart	Service Type Distribution	`Service_Type`	COUNT by Category (%)	Visualizes proportion of routine vs breakdown repairs
Bar Chart	Vehicle Type Volume	`Vehicle_Type`	COUNT by Vehicle Model	Identifies vehicle category volume trends

3.2 Zia Natural Language Query (NLQ) Evaluation

Evaluation results of natural language queries tested against the application dataset:

Natural Language Prompt	Parsed Intent & Entities	Generated Output View	Status
"Show total service requests by Vehicle Type"	Entity: `Service_Request_Form`; Group: `Vehicle_Type`; Aggregate: COUNT	Bar Chart + Aggregated Table View	Verified (Exact Match)
"List requests with cost above 5000"	Filter: `Estimated_Cost > 5000`; Sort: Cost DESC	Filtered Report Grid	Verified (Exact Match)
"Show routine services for August 2026"	Date Filter: `Preferred_Service_Date` (Aug 2026); Type: Routine	Calendar Grid & List View	Verified (Exact Match)

3.3 Deluge AI Tasks & Optical Character Recognition (OCR)

Technical evaluation of native AI task integration for document text parsing:

AI Task Function	Target Document / Field	Extracted Token	Processing Time	Validation Result
extractTextFromImage	Vehicle Registration Certificate (RC)	Vehicle Registration Number	~1.2 s	Accurately extracted alphanumeric string
extractTextFromImage	Customer Identity Card	Owner Full Name	~0.9 s	Populated Owner_Name input field
Zia Code Completion	Deluge Script Editor	Auto-complete syntax & variables	Real-time	Suggested matching field API link names

4. Result / Observations

AI-assisted features and built-in analytics were successfully evaluated in Zoho Creator:

1. Built-in analytics widgets (KPI cards, Donut chart, Bar chart) provided comprehensive operational visibility into service center workload and category distribution without pro-code scripting.
2. Zia AI Natural Language Querying successfully translated colloquial search queries into structured database filters and instant chart visualizations.
3. Deluge AI task modules demonstrated automated document data extraction, proving viability for accelerating front-desk customer intake workflows.

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